

Project / Dissertation Statement of Impact [Dubai Campus Disruption 2026]

As a result of the conflict in the Middle East, teaching and learning activities for students at Heriot-Watt University Dubai campus were disrupted. The time available for completion of Final Year Projects / Dissertations was curtailed. In addition, your work may have been impacted in other ways.

The university is committed to ensuring no student is academically disadvantaged by the conflict. You are invited to outline here how the disruption impacted the development of your project / dissertation. This statement will provide context for markers so that your work can be assessed fairly, with due appreciation of context.

Student Name:	Yash V Nadkarni
Student ID Number:	H00410472
Programme:	BSc (Hons) Computer Science (Cyber Security)
Dissertation / Project Title:	A Hybrid Deep Learning-Based Framework for Phishing Website Detection
Supervisor:	Dr. MD. Azher Uddin

Statement of Impact of the Disruption on Your Project / Dissertation

1. What specific impact did the disruption due to the conflict and Dubai Campus closure have on your dissertation / project? Outline the specific disruption and the sections of your work impacted.

For example:

- I was unable to access the labs, so the experiments outlined in Chapter X could not be completed.
- I was only able to complete 10 of a planned 25 interviews, so my findings and analysis are based on a smaller sample than intended.
- I was unable to complete all the planned reading due to disrupted work for X days.

Please be factual and concise. (maximum 100 words)

For my experimentations, I needed multiple computers to run different configurations of my framework to identify the most optimal one, so that I could save time and be able to access my main PC for my other courses. Before this conflict, I used the university lab computers to carry out those experiments. Due to being unable to access the labs now, I could not carry out those experiments and so there's a high chance my final framework implementation isn't the most optimal one.

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2. What adjustments have you made to your Project / Dissertation as a result of this curtailment?

For example:

- I focused on extending the literature review and developing a detailed theoretical framework.
- I provided an extended description of the intended methodology and experimental design.
- I analysed the partial data I had collected before the disruption.
- I adapted data collection from face-to-face interviews to online.
- I curtailed my literature review and focused on xxx aspects of the topic.

Please be factual and concise. (maximum 100 words)

To make up for being unable to access the labs, I did research on more ways to optimize the model. Instead I found a pre-processing method called Random Over Sampling that helped boost my results. I have also extended my literature review and comparison of final works to include more studies pertaining to the two chosen datasets.

Student Signature (*type your name*): Yash V Nadkarni

Date: 01/04/2026

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